

A PRELIMINARY MINI PROJECT REPORT ON

“Finance Connect – A real-time collaborative advisory platform where entrepreneurs connect with expert advisors, share requirements, and build scalable ventures through intelligent matching and guided mentorship”

SUBMITTED TOWARDS THE PARTIAL FULFILLMENT OF THE

REQUIREMENTS OF

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING (T.Y. B. Tech.)

Academic Year: 2024-25

SUBMITTED BY

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PIMPRI CHINCHWAD COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING
DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER ENGINEERING,

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that, the mini project entitled **“Finance Connect – A real-time collaborative advisory platform where entrepreneurs connect with expert advisors, share requirements, and build scalable ventures through intelligent matching and guided mentorship”** is successfully carried out as a mini project for Full Stack Development Laboratory and successfully submitted by following students of “PCET's Pimpri Chinchwad College of Engineering, Nigdi, Pune-44”.

Under the Guidance of Dr. Namrata Gawande & Prof. Abhishek Raut
IN THE PARTIAL FULFILLMENT OF THE REQUIREMENTS OF
BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING (T.Y. B. Tech.)

Submitted By

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Dr. Namrata Gawande
Prof. Abhishek Raut
Project Guide

Abstract

Finance Connect is a real-time advisory and mentorship platform developed using the MERN (MongoDB, Express.js, React.js, Node.js) stack. The system is designed to bridge the gap between entrepreneurs and expert advisors by providing a structured environment where users can connect, share requirements, and receive guided support for business growth. The primary objective of this project is to enhance decision-making and startup development by enabling seamless collaboration between idea generators and industry experts through a web-based platform.

The platform integrates Artificial Intelligence using OpenRouter APIs to extract meaningful keywords from user-provided requirements and intelligently match entrepreneurs with suitable advisors based on their expertise. It supports real-time interaction workflows where entrepreneurs can send connection requests, and advisors can review, accept, and guide them through structured mentorship. MongoDB is used for efficient data storage, maintaining user profiles, requests, and interaction history for persistence and scalability.

Finance Connect features a modular and secure architecture with authentication implemented using JSON Web Tokens (JWT). The system includes dedicated dashboards for entrepreneurs and advisors, providing functionalities such as requirement submission, advisor discovery, request management, and meeting scheduling. Advisors can share meeting links and communicate further via integrated workflows, ensuring a smooth and professional interaction process.

The frontend delivers a modern and responsive user interface, ensuring accessibility and ease of use across devices. Additional features such as request status tracking, AI-driven recommendations, and structured communication enhance the overall user experience. This project demonstrates the practical implementation of full-stack development, intelligent matching systems, and real-time workflow management.

Finance Connect addresses the growing need for accessible mentorship and guidance in the entrepreneurial ecosystem and showcases how modern web technologies combined with AI can create scalable, efficient, and impactful collaboration platforms.

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CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

a) Problem Statement

In today's entrepreneurial ecosystem, access to the right guidance and mentorship is a critical factor for startup success. However, aspiring entrepreneurs often face challenges in identifying suitable advisors, communicating their requirements effectively, and receiving timely expert support. Existing platforms either lack intelligent matching systems, are limited to static directories, or require manual searching, which is time-consuming and inefficient.

Entrepreneurs also struggle with fragmented communication channels, where requirement sharing, advisor discovery, and interaction occur across multiple disconnected platforms. This leads to delays, miscommunication, and reduced productivity. Additionally, many users lack the technical expertise to clearly define their needs in structured formats, making it difficult to find the most relevant advisors.

There is a need for a unified platform that enables entrepreneurs to describe their requirements in simple language, automatically extract meaningful insights, match them with suitable advisors, and facilitate structured interaction within a single system. The absence of such an integrated solution limits innovation, slows down decision-making, and creates barriers to effective mentorship.

b) Project Idea

The proposed system, **Finance Connect**, is an AI-driven advisory and mentorship platform built using the MERN stack. The platform enables entrepreneurs to submit their business requirements through a user-friendly interface, after which the system uses AI (OpenRouter) to extract relevant keywords and intelligently match them with suitable advisors based on their expertise.

The system provides dedicated dashboards for entrepreneurs and advisors. Entrepreneurs can discover matched advisors and send connection requests, while advisors can review incoming requests, accept them, and guide entrepreneurs through structured interaction workflows. The platform also includes features such as request tracking, meeting scheduling via shared links, and persistent interaction records.

By integrating AI-based matching, real-time request management, and structured communication, Finance Connect aims to provide an all-in-one digital mentorship ecosystem accessible through a web browser.

c) Motivation

With the rapid growth of startups, innovation hubs, and digital entrepreneurship, the demand for accessible mentorship and expert guidance has significantly increased. Many entrepreneurs, especially beginners, lack direct access to experienced advisors, which hinders their ability to make informed decisions and scale their ideas effectively.

Existing solutions are either overly complex, lack personalization, or fail to provide intelligent matching between entrepreneurs and advisors. This creates a gap where users spend excessive time searching for relevant guidance instead of focusing on building their ventures.

The motivation behind Finance Connect is to develop a smart and efficient platform that simplifies the mentorship process by combining AI-driven insights, structured workflows, and intuitive user interfaces. This project also provides an opportunity to explore advanced full-stack development concepts such as intelligent recommendation systems, secure authentication, and scalable backend architecture.

d) Scope

The scope of Finance Connect includes the design and implementation of a web-based advisory platform with the following capabilities:

- User authentication and secure session management using JWT
- Profile creation and role-based access (Entrepreneur and Advisor)
- Requirement submission through a text-based input system
- AI-based keyword extraction using OpenRouter APIs
- Intelligent matching of entrepreneurs with relevant advisors
- Dashboard interfaces for both entrepreneurs and advisors
- Connection request system between users
- Request status tracking (pending, accepted)
- Meeting scheduling via shared links (e.g., Google Meet)
- Persistent storage of user data, requests, and interactions using MongoDB

The system is designed for startup mentorship, business consultation, and guidance platforms. Advanced features such as real-time video conferencing, automated scheduling systems, large-scale recommendation optimization, and enterprise-level security can be considered as future enhancements but are beyond the current scope.

e) Literature Survey / Requirement Analysis

Literature Survey

Several existing platforms provide mentorship and advisory services for entrepreneurs, including networking platforms, consultancy portals, and professional communities. However, most of these systems rely on manual search mechanisms where users must browse through advisor profiles without intelligent assistance. This often leads to inefficient matching and increased time in finding suitable guidance.

Some platforms offer communication features such as messaging or video calls, but they lack structured workflows for requirement submission, request tracking, and advisor selection. Additionally, many systems do not incorporate Artificial Intelligence to analyze user needs and provide personalized recommendations, which limits their effectiveness.

The study of existing solutions indicates a clear gap in providing a unified platform that combines requirement understanding, AI-based advisor matching, and structured interaction workflows. Finance Connect addresses this gap by integrating AI with a user-friendly advisory system to deliver a seamless and efficient mentorship experience.

Requirement Analysis

Functional Requirements:

- User registration and login using secure authentication (JWT)
- Profile creation with role-based access (Entrepreneur / Advisor)
- Submission of business requirements through a text-based interface
- AI-based keyword extraction from user input using OpenRouter APIs
- Intelligent matching of entrepreneurs with relevant advisors
- Display of matched advisors on the entrepreneur dashboard
- Sending connection requests from entrepreneurs to advisors
- Viewing and managing incoming requests on the advisor dashboard
- Accepting or rejecting connection requests
- Adding and sharing meeting links (e.g., Google Meet)
- Tracking request status (pending, accepted)
- Retrieving and displaying past interaction data

Non-Functional Requirements:

- Low latency in real-time updates
- Secure handling of user data and authentication tokens
- Scalability to support multiple concurrent users
- User-friendly and responsive interface
- Reliability and fault tolerance during communication
- Efficient backend processing for code execution

This analysis ensures that the system is both functional and efficient, meeting user expectations while maintaining performance and security standards.

CHAPTER 2: PROJECT DESIGN

a) Hardware, Software, Resources, Requirements & Detailed Explanation

Hardware Requirements:

The system does not require high-end hardware and can run efficiently on standard computing devices.

- **Processor:** Intel i3 / AMD equivalent or higher
- **RAM:** Minimum 4 GB (8 GB recommended for smooth performance)
- **Storage:** At least 1 GB free space
- **Network:** Stable internet connection for real-time communication

Explanation:

Since Finance Connect is a web-based application, most processing is handled on the server side, including AI-based keyword extraction, matching logic, and database operations. The client primarily handles user interaction, dashboard rendering, and API communication. A stable internet connection is essential to ensure smooth data exchange between frontend and backend services.

Software Requirements:

Frontend:

- React.js
- Axios (API communication)
- React Router (navigation)
- CSS / Tailwind CSS (styling)

Backend:

- Node.js
- Express.js
- MongoDB (database)
- Mongoose (ODM for MongoDB)
- JWT (authentication)

AI Integration:

- OpenRouter API (for keyword extraction and intelligent matching)

Development Tools:

- VS Code (code editor)
- Postman (API testing)
- Git & GitHub (version control)

Explanation:

The MERN stack provides a full JavaScript-based ecosystem, ensuring seamless integration between frontend and backend. MongoDB is used for flexible and scalable data storage.

Resources:

- Open-source libraries and frameworks
- Online documentation and community support
- Local MongoDB instance for development
- System compilers for multi-language execution

Explanation:

The project leverages open-source technologies, making it cost-effective and highly customizable. External dependencies such as compilers are required for executing code in different programming languages.

Functional Requirements:

- User registration and login using secure authentication (JWT)
- Profile creation with role-based access (Entrepreneur / Advisor)
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- Intelligent matching of entrepreneurs with relevant advisors
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- Viewing and managing incoming requests on the advisor dashboard
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- Adding and sharing meeting links (e.g., Google Meet)
- Tracking request status (pending, accepted)
- Retrieving and displaying past interaction data

Non-Functional Requirements:

- Low latency in real-time updates
- Secure handling of user data and authentication tokens
- Scalability to support multiple concurrent users
- User-friendly and responsive interface
- Reliability and fault tolerance during communication
- Efficient backend processing for code execution

b) Dataset Design

Finance Connect does not rely on traditional static datasets but utilizes a structured database to store dynamic user, profile, and interaction data. The database is designed using MongoDB with the following collections:

1. User Collection:

Fields:

- userId (ObjectId)
- email (String)
- password (Hashed String)
- role (String – Entrepreneur / Advisor)
- name (String)
- phone (String)
- bio (String)
- address (String)
- startupName (String – for Entrepreneurs)
- startupStage (String – for Entrepreneurs)
- industry (String – for Entrepreneurs)
- expertise (String – for Advisors)
- experience (Number – for Advisors)
- document (String – uploaded proof)
- isProfileComplete (Boolean)

- createdAt (Date)
- updatedAt (Date)

Explanation:

This collection is used for authentication and storing complete user profiles. It supports role-based functionality, where entrepreneurs and advisors have different attributes. The isProfileComplete flag ensures that only users with completed profiles can access dashboards and system features.

2. Request Collection:

Stores connection requests between entrepreneurs and advisors.

Fields:

- requestId (ObjectId)
- entrepreneurId (UserId reference)
- advisorId (UserId reference)
- requirement (String)
- keywords (Array of Strings)
- status (String – pending / accepted)
- meetLink (String)
- createdAt (Date)
- updatedAt (Date)

Explanation:

This collection acts as the core interaction layer of the system. It tracks requests sent by entrepreneurs to advisors, including the requirement description and extracted keywords. It also stores the request status and meeting link once the advisor accepts and schedules a session.

Data Relationships:

- One user (Entrepreneur) can send multiple requests
- One user (Advisor) can receive multiple requests
- Each request is linked to one entrepreneur and one advisor
- One advisor can be matched with multiple entrepreneurs
- AI-generated keywords are used to map entrepreneur requirements with advisor expertise

c) Hours Estimation

The estimated time required to complete the project is structured as follows:

Phase	Task	Estimated Hours
1	Requirement Analysis & Planning	6–8 hrs
2	UI/UX Design (Figma / Dashboard Layout Planning)	8–10 hrs
3	Frontend Development (React + Components)	20–25 hrs
4	Backend Development (API + Database)	20–25 hrs
5	AI Integration (OpenRouter Keyword Extraction)	10–12 hrs
6	Matching Logic & Request Workflow Implementation	12–15 hrs
7	Testing & Debugging	10–12 hrs
8	Final Integration & Deployment Preparation	6–8 hrs

Total Estimated Time: ~ 95 to 115 hours

Explanation:

The project requires careful implementation of AI-driven matching and structured interaction workflows between entrepreneurs and advisors. Additional effort is needed to ensure accurate keyword extraction, efficient database queries, and smooth request handling between both dashboards.

Time is also spent on designing intuitive user interfaces for both roles and ensuring seamless navigation and user experience. Testing plays a critical role in validating request flows, authentication, and data consistency.

Proper planning and phased execution help in managing complexity and ensuring that the system is completed efficiently within the estimated timeline while maintaining performance and reliability

CHAPTER 3: Module Description

a) Block Diagram with Explanation of Each Module

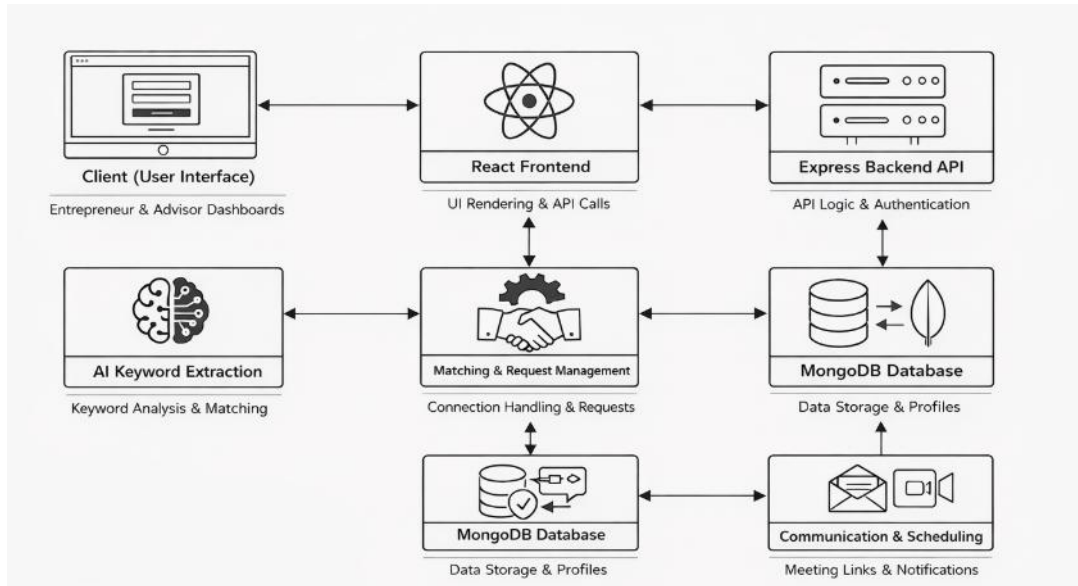


Fig.1 Block Diagram

Module Explanation

1. Client (User Interface)

- Accessed through a web browser
- Allows users to register, login, and complete their profiles
- Provides separate dashboards for Entrepreneurs and Advisors
- Displays requirement form, matched advisors, request status, and meeting details

2. React Frontend

- Handles UI rendering and state management
- Provides dynamic dashboards for both user roles
- Communicates with backend using REST APIs
- Displays AI-generated keywords and matched advisor results

3.AI Integration (OpenRouter API)

- Processes user-entered requirements using Natural Language Processing
- Extracts relevant keywords from text input
- Enhances matching accuracy between entrepreneurs and advisors
- Returns processed data to backend for further filtering

4. Express Backend API

- Handles authentication using JWT
- Manages user profiles and role-based access
- Processes entrepreneur requirements and matching logic
- Provides APIs for sending requests, accepting requests, and storing data

5. Matching & Request Management Module

- Matches entrepreneurs with advisors based on extracted keywords and expertise
- Manages connection requests between users
- Tracks request status (pending, accepted)
- Handles meeting link storage and updates

6. MongoDB Database

- Stores user profiles, roles, and authentication data
- Maintains request data and interaction history
- Ensures persistent storage and data consistency
- Supports scalable and flexible schema design

7. Communication & Scheduling Module

- Enables structured interaction between entrepreneurs and advisors
- Allows advisors to share meeting links (e.g., Google Meet)
- Supports follow-up communication through external email integration
- Provides status updates and notifications within dashboards

b) Comparative Study

Feature	Traditional Mentorship Approach	Existing Advisory Platforms	Finance Connect
Setup Required	Manual networking & outreach	Account setup required	Simple web-based access
Advisor Discovery	Time-consuming, manual search	Directory-based	AI-driven matching
Requirement Understanding	Informal / unstructured	Limited	AI-based keyword extraction
Real-time Interaction Flow	Not structured	Partially available	Fully structured workflow
Request Management	Not available	Limited	Fully supported
Meeting Scheduling	Manual coordination	External tools required	Integrated link sharing
Accessibility	Location dependent	Web-based	Web-based
Personalization	Low	Moderate	High (AI-driven)
Cost	Often high (consultations)	Sometimes paid	Free
Efficiency	Low	Moderate	High

Explanation

Traditional Mentorship Approach:

Entrepreneurs rely on personal networks, events, or referrals to find advisors. This process is time-consuming, unstructured, and lacks scalability.

Existing Advisory Platforms:

These platforms provide basic directories of advisors and limited communication features. However, they often lack intelligent matching, structured workflows, and seamless integration of requirement submission, making the process less efficient

Finance Connect:

Finance Connect integrates AI-driven keyword extraction, intelligent advisor matching, and structured request workflows into a single platform. It eliminates manual searching, improves accuracy in advisor selection, and provides a streamlined interaction process from requirement submission to meeting scheduling.

CHAPTER 4: RESULTS & DISCUSSION

a) Source Code

The complete source code of Finance Connect is developed using the MERN stack and is divided into three main parts:

1. Frontend (React)

Key Components:

- Authentication pages (Login / Register)
- Profile completion pages (Entrepreneur / Advisor)
- Entrepreneur Dashboard (Requirement input, advisor matching, request tracking)
- Advisor Dashboard (Incoming requests, accept/reject, meeting link sharing)
- Context APIs for authentication and state management

Example (API Call for Matching Advisors):

```
const res = await fetch("http://localhost:5000/api/dashboard/find-advisors", {
  method: "POST",
  headers: { "Content-Type": "application/json" },
  body: JSON.stringify({ keywords }),
});
const data = await res.json();
setAdvisors(data);
```

2. Backend (Node + Express)

Key Modules:

- Authentication (JWT-based)
- User profile management
- AI keyword extraction integration (OpenRouter API)
- Advisor matching logic
- Request management APIs (send, accept, meeting link)

Example (Request Handling):

```
router.post("/send", async (req, res) => {
  const request = await Request.create(req.body);
  res.json(request);
});
```

3. Database (MongoDB)

Collections used:

- Users
- Requests

Explanation

The source code follows a modular and scalable architecture. The frontend manages UI and user interaction, while the backend handles business logic, AI integration, and request workflows. MongoDB ensures efficient and persistent data storage for users and interactions.

b) Screenshots including GUI



Fig.2 Home page

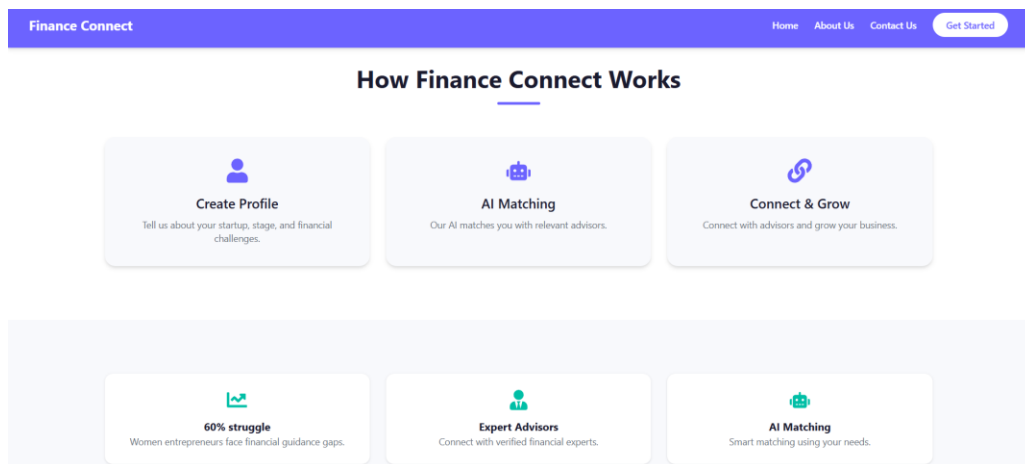


Fig.3 Home page

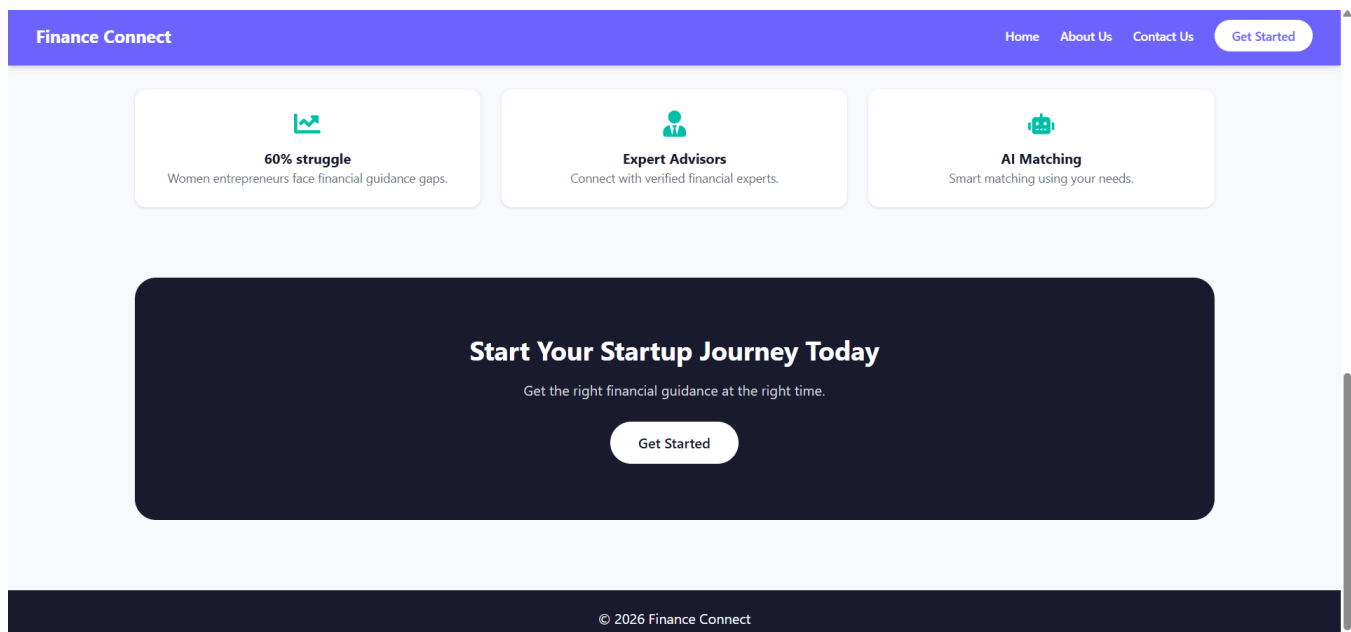


Fig.3 Home page

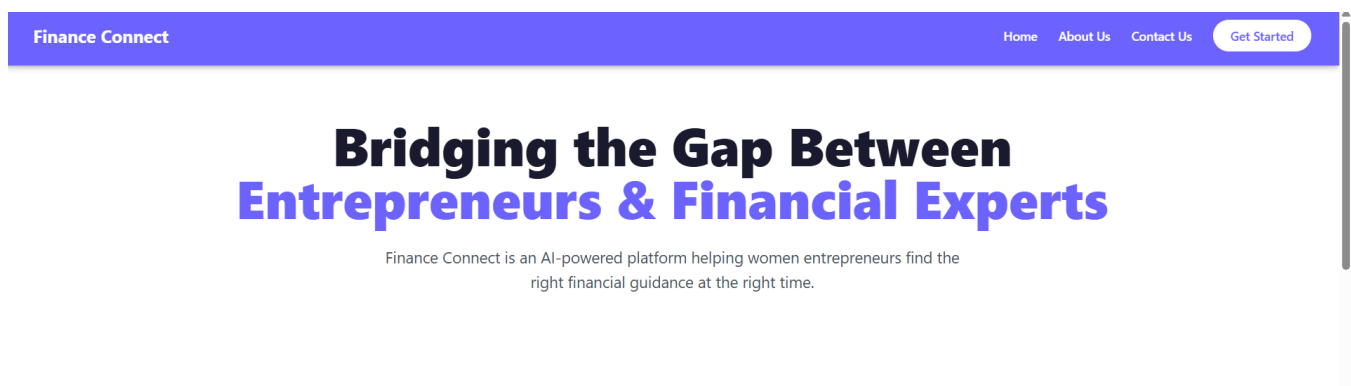


Fig.4 About us page

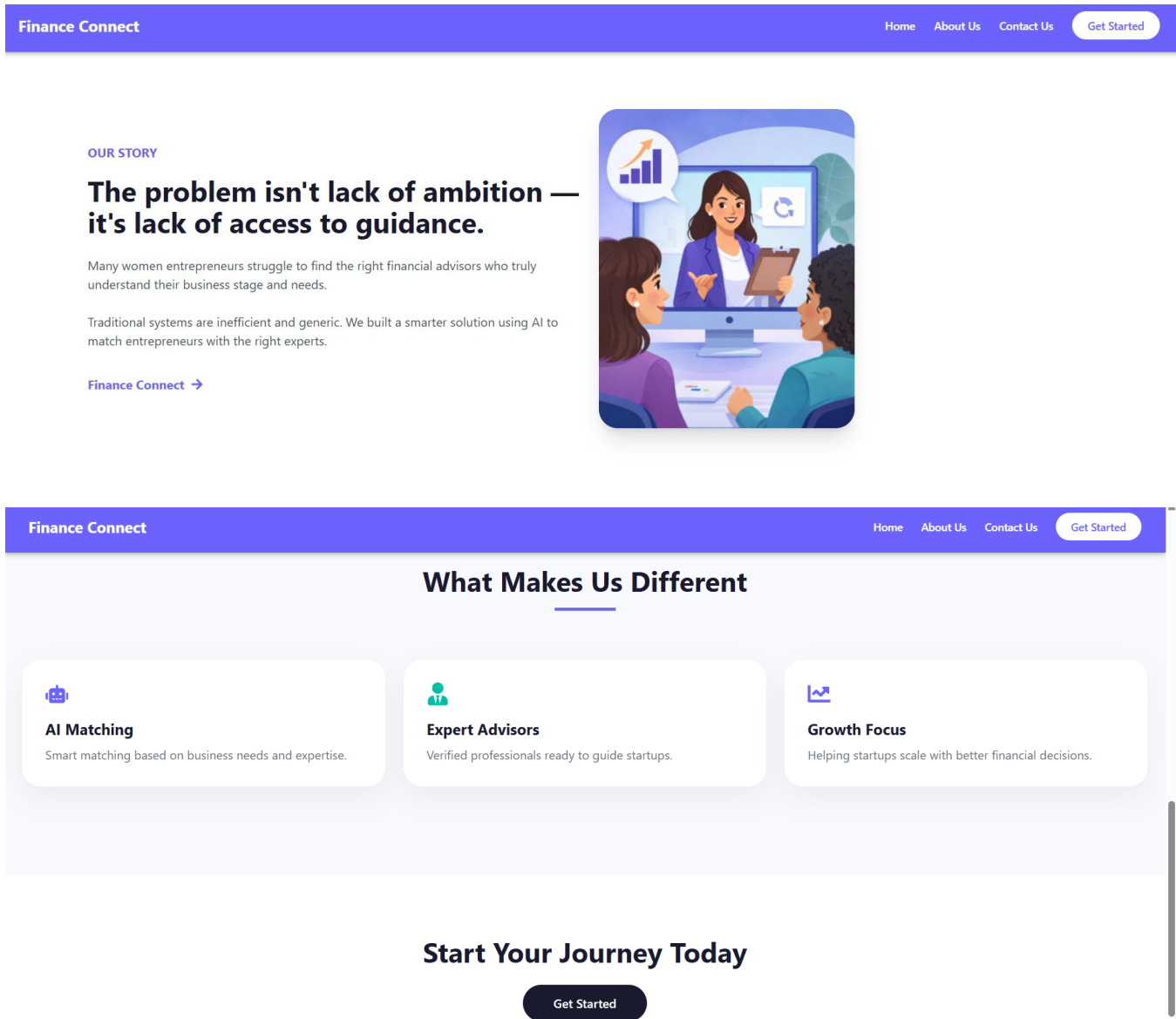


Fig.5. About us page

Finance Connect

[Home](#)[About Us](#)[Contact Us](#)

Get Started

Send a Message

Your Name

Your Email

Your Message

Send Message

✉ support@financeconnect.com

+91 7777777777

Pune, India

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Fig.6 Contact Us page

Finance Connect

[Home](#)[About Us](#)[Contact Us](#)

Get Started

Join Finance Connect

STARTUP

For Entrepreneurs

Get financial guidance and connect with expert advisors.

Login

Don't have an account? [Sign up](#)

EXPERT

For Advisors

Help startups grow with your expertise.

Login

Don't have an account? [Sign up](#)

Fig.7 Login Page

Finance Connect

[Home](#)[About Us](#)[Contact Us](#)[Get Started](#)

← Back

Welcome Back

enter5@gmail.com

.....

Show

✓ Registration successful! Please login.

Log In

Don't have an account? [Sign up](#)

Finance Connect

[Home](#)[About Us](#)[Contact Us](#)[Get Started](#)

Logout

Complete Your Profile

100% Completed

Rahul Mehta

7888888888

Chartered Accountant with 8 years experience in startup fina

Pune

FinEase

Early Stage

FinTech

Choose File

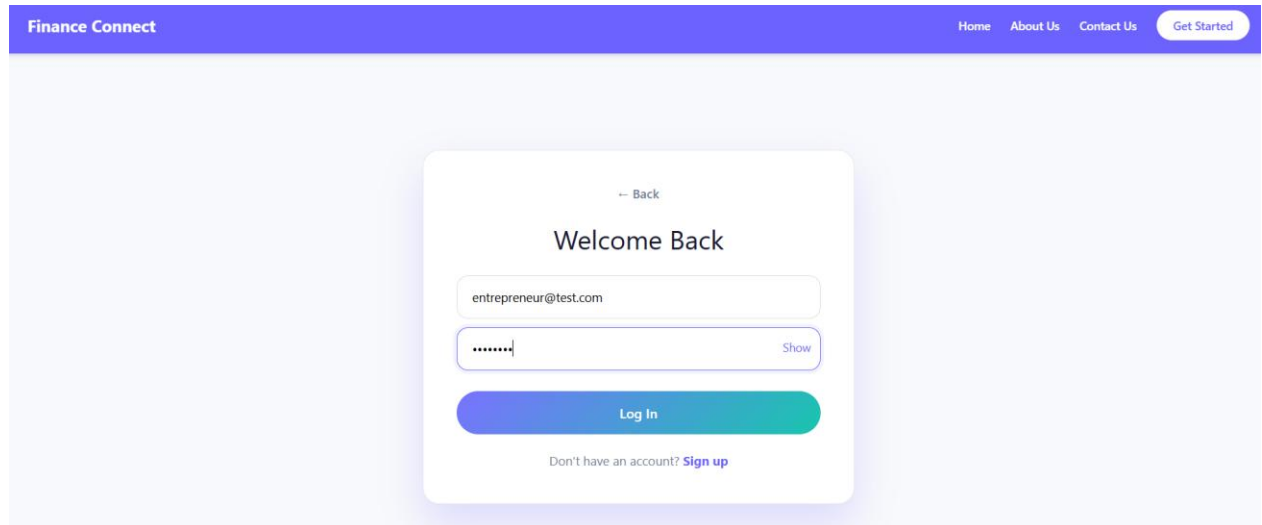
resume.docx

Uploaded: resume.docx

Submit Profile

Fig.8 Profile page

17



The image shows a web application interface for "Finance Connect". At the top, there is a blue navigation bar with the text "Finance Connect" on the left and links for "Home", "About Us", "Contact Us", and a "Get Started" button on the right. The main content area has a light blue background. In the center, there is a white login card with a subtle shadow. The card contains a link to go back, a "Welcome Back" heading, an email input field with "entrepreneur@test.com", a password input field with masked characters and a "Show" toggle, a "Log In" button, and a link to "Sign up" for users who don't have an account.

Finance Connect

Home About Us Contact Us Get Started

← Back

Welcome Back

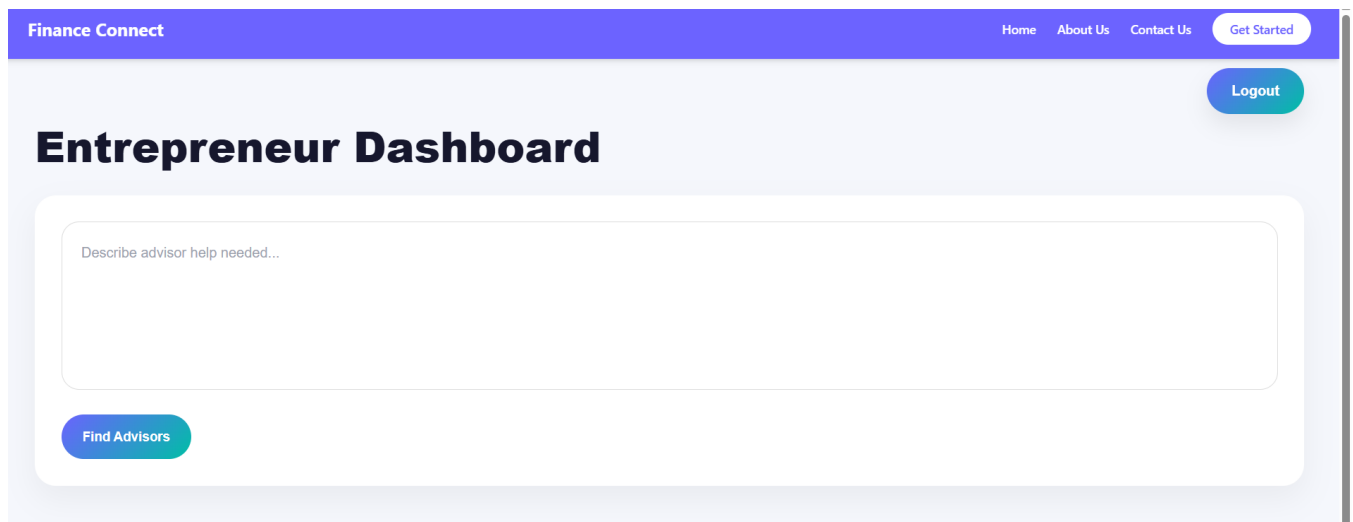
entrepreneur@test.com

..... Show

Log In

Don't have an account? [Sign up](#)

Fig.9 Login as entrepreneur



The image shows the "Entrepreneur Dashboard" within the "Finance Connect" application. The top navigation bar is blue with "Finance Connect" on the left and links for "Home", "About Us", "Contact Us", and a "Get Started" button on the right. A "Logout" button is located in the top right corner of the dashboard area. The main heading is "Entrepreneur Dashboard". Below this, there is a large white text area with a placeholder "Describe advisor help needed...". At the bottom left of this area is a "Find Advisors" button.

Finance Connect

Home About Us Contact Us Get Started

Logout

Entrepreneur Dashboard

Describe advisor help needed...

Find Advisors

Fig.10 Entrepreneur Dashboard

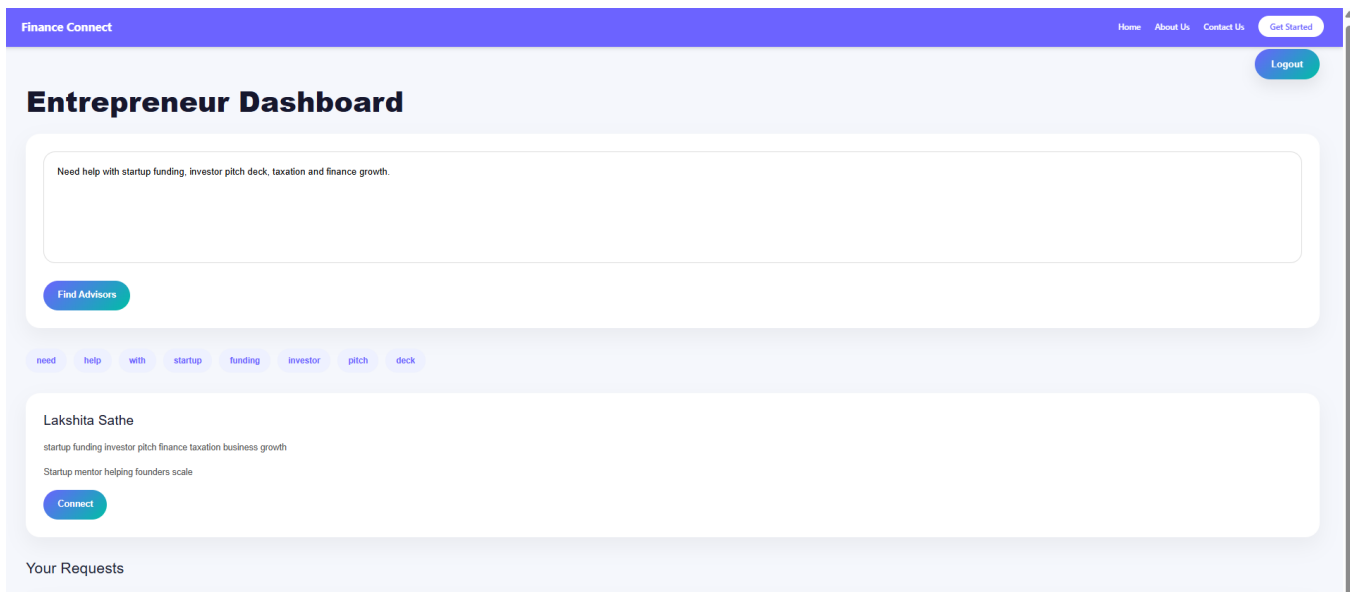


Fig.11 Entrepreneur Dashboard

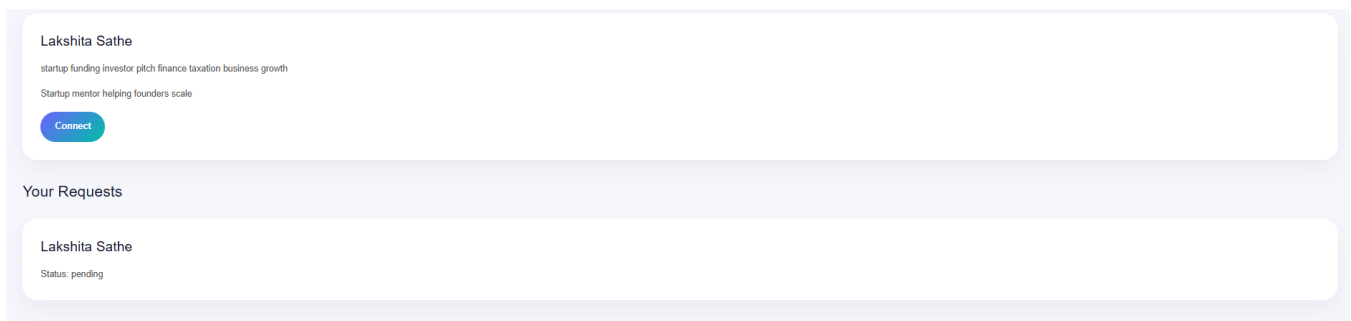


Fig.12 Entrepreneur Dashboard- Connections

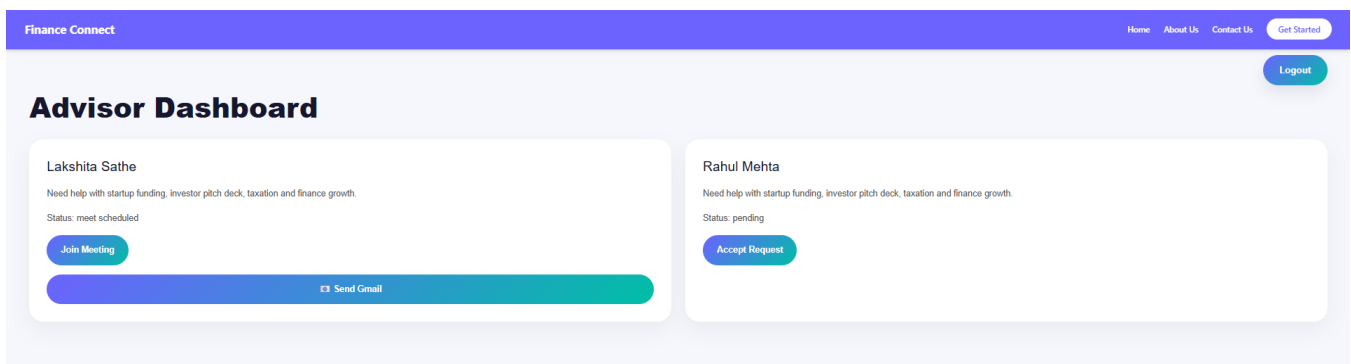


Fig.13 Advisor Dashboard

Meeting Scheduled

advisor@test.com

Meeting Scheduled

Hello Lakshita Sathe,Your meeting is scheduled.Link:https://meet.google.com/wftv-opog-mgo

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Fig.14 Send Email -Advisor Dashboard

Your Requests

Lakshita Sathe

Status: meet scheduled

Check your email for meeting details.

Join Meeting

Fig.15 Advisor requesets

Backend mongo DB

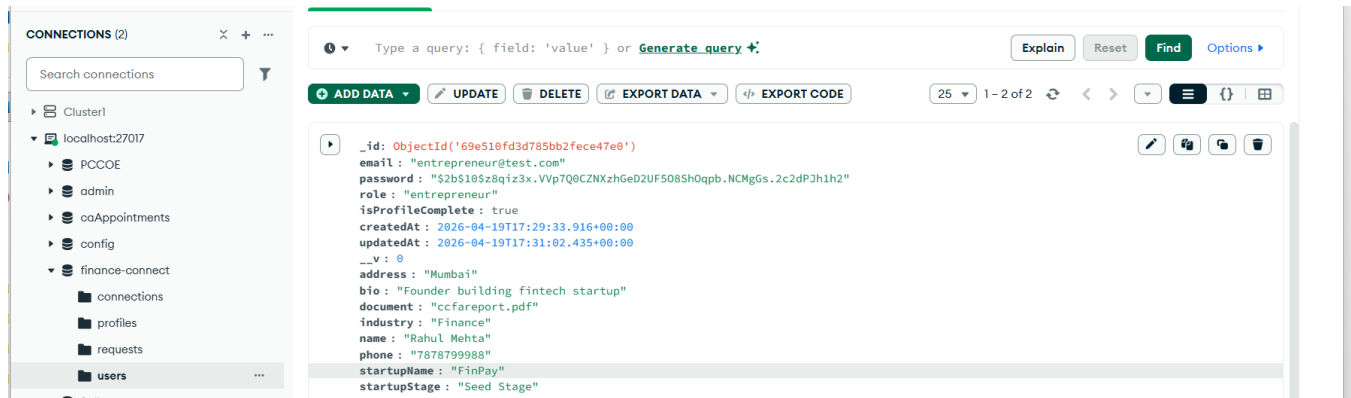


Fig.16 Mongoddb

c) Test Cases

Test Case ID	Description	Input	Expected Output	Result
TC01	User Registration	Valid email, password, role	Account created successfully	Pass
TC02	User Login	Valid credentials	Redirect to dashboard	Pass
TC03	Invalid Login	Wrong password	Error message displayed	Pass
TC04	Profile Completion	Valid user details	Profile saved successfully	Pass
TC05	AI Keyword Extraction	Requirement text	Keywords extracted correctly	Pass
TC06	Advisor Matching	Keywords input	Relevant advisors displayed	Pass
TC07	Send Request	Advisor selected	Request created successfully	Pass
TC08	View Requests (Advisor)	Advisor login	Requests displayed	Pass
TC09	Accept Request	Click accept	Status updated to accepted	Pass
TC10	Add Meeting Link	Valid Google Meet link	Link saved successfully	Pass

TC11	Request Status Tracking	Entrepreneur dashboard	Status updated correctly	Pass
TC12	Data Persistence	Reload dashboard	Data remains intact	Pass

Discussion

The system was tested across multiple scenarios, including user authentication, AI-based matching, and interaction workflows between entrepreneurs and advisors. The results demonstrate that:

- AI keyword extraction works efficiently for understanding user requirements
- Advisor matching provides relevant and accurate results
- Request handling and status tracking function smoothly
- The meeting link workflow enables structured communication
- The system maintains stability with multiple users

Overall, Finance Connect successfully achieves its objective of simplifying mentorship and advisory interactions. Future improvements such as enhanced recommendation algorithms and real-time communication features can further strengthen the platform.

CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION

The development of Finance Connect, an AI-driven advisory and mentorship platform, successfully demonstrates the practical implementation of modern full-stack technologies to address real-world challenges in the entrepreneurial ecosystem. The system bridges the gap between entrepreneurs and expert advisors by providing an intelligent, structured, and user-friendly platform.

Using the MERN stack, the application achieves a scalable and modular architecture, while AI integration enables efficient keyword extraction and accurate advisor matching. Features such as request management, meeting scheduling, and dashboard-based workflows enhance usability and streamline the mentorship process.

The project fulfills all defined objectives, including secure authentication, intelligent matching, and persistent data management. It also highlights key concepts such as RESTful API design, role-based systems, and AI-assisted decision-making.

Overall, Finance Connect provides an efficient, accessible, and scalable solution for connecting entrepreneurs with the right expertise.

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9. MDN Web Docs – <https://developer.mozilla.org/>
10. GeeksforGeeks – Real-time Web Applications Concepts

Annexure

Mini Project Plagiarism Report

The screenshot displays a plagiarism report interface. At the top, the 'PaperRater' logo is on the left, and navigation links for 'AI Humanizer', 'Grammar & Spelling', 'Plagiarism Checker', and 'Resources' are in the center. 'Login' and 'Sign Up' buttons are on the right. The main content area shows a document snippet on the left and a results panel on the right. The results panel indicates a '99% original' score and a 'Congratulations! This paper seems to be original.' message. Below this, a list of sources is shown with their respective match percentages:

Source	Match Percentage
arxiv.org	0.2% match
https://arxiv.org/abs/1805.00745	
www.studymode.com	0.2% match
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